Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 10 9 3
♥ 6 4
♦ A 6 4
♣ 10 8 6 3

♠ 4
♥ A K 10 9 8 5
♦ 10 2
♣ A Q J 7

♠ J 5 2
♥ Q J 2
♦ 9 8 5 3
♣ K 5 4

♠ A Q 8 7 6
♥ 7 3
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 9 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
2♥	3♠		
All Pass			

3♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

You would have bid 2♠ if West had not overcalled.

Instead, with 4 trumps you can jump to 3♠ as a preemptive measure. Partner will not mistake this for a limit raise since you would have cue-bid with 11+ points and support.

The jump to 3 is based on the Law of Total Tricks - bidding to a trick level equal to the number of your side's trumps.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ 8 4 3 ♥ K 10 6 4 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ Q 9 3	
♠ A K 10 9 5 2 ♥ 8 3 2 ♦ K ♣ J 7 4	N W E S	♠ Q 7 ♥ A ♦ 10 9 8 6 3 2 ♣ 10 8 6 2
	♠ J 6 ♥ Q J 9 7 5 ♦ J 7 4 ♣ A K 5	

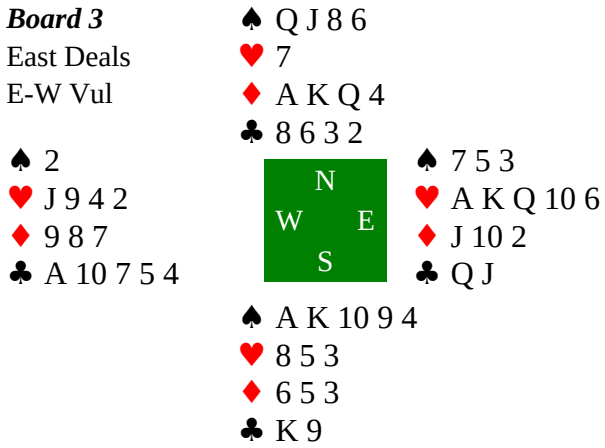
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
1♠	2♠	Pass	3♥
All Pass			

3♥ by South
Lead: ♠K

Partner has a limit raise or better in ♥s, 11 points or more.

You, however, have a bare-bones minimum. So you rebid a minimum 3♥, which partner passes.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥4

You have 14 points in support of ♠s; however, partner's overcall does not promise more than 9 points or so.

So you cue-bid 2♥, showing a good hand with support and forcing partner to bid again. Partner bids 3♠.

4♠. Partner's jump shows a good overcall, but not enough strength to insist on game when you might have only 11 points. You have plenty extra so you bid the game.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ J 10 9 8 ♥ J 9 4 ♦ A 8 6 2 ♣ A J	
♠ 7 5 ♥ A K Q 10 5 3 ♦ J 10 5 ♣ 6 4		♠ 3 ♥ 7 6 2 ♦ 9 7 3 ♣ 10 9 8 7 3 2
	♠ A K Q 6 4 2 ♥ 8 ♦ K Q 4 ♣ K Q 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
2♥	3♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

Partner has a limit raise or better in ♠s, 11 points or more.

There is only one thing you want to know now - how many Aces partner holds. So you bid 4NT to find out. Partner responds 5♥.

You know you have a loser. Bid 6♠.